

MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS

Music was the main form of entertainment in Renaissance Europe. Composers experimented with new instruments and different ways of singing in harmony.



RAUSCHPFEIFE
Reeded wind instrument



BASS RECORDER
Wind instrument



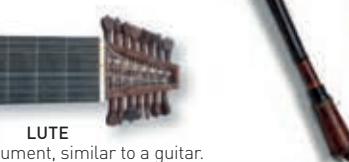
RACKETT
Wind instrument



REBEC
Stringed instrument
played with a bow.



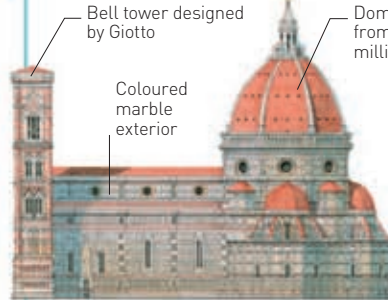
TENOR CRUMHORN
Wind instrument



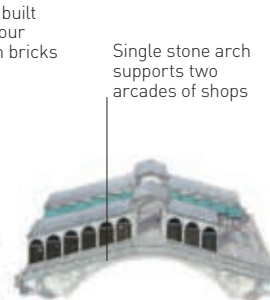
LUTE
Stringed instrument, similar to a guitar.

GOLDEN AGE OF ARCHITECTURE

Architects were inspired by the ruins of Ancient Roman and Greek buildings. They studied ancient writings on geometry and proportion in order to make buildings that were both beautiful to look at and suited to their purpose.



DUOMO, FLORENCE
Completed in 1436, the *duomo* (cathedral) is topped by a huge, octagonal dome designed by sculptor and architect Filippo Brunelleschi.



RIALTO BRIDGE, VENICE
A late Renaissance masterpiece of architecture and engineering, completed in 1591.



ST PETER'S BASILICA, ROME
Over a 120-year period, many of Italy's finest architects worked on the building. It was completed in 1626.



VIRGIN AND CHILD (c.1480)
Carlo Crivelli

A REVOLUTION IN ART

A way of thinking called humanism became popular during the Renaissance. Humanism's focus on the experiences and achievements of real human beings had a huge influence on artists. They started to portray people, including religious figures, as realistically as possible, and to place them in more everyday situations.



MONA LISA (1503–06)
Leonardo da Vinci



FRESCO (WALL PAINTING) OF THE QUEEN OF SHEBA (1466)
Piero della Francesca



STATUE OF DAVID (1501–04)
Michelangelo



PIETA (MARY HOLDING JESUS) (1553)
Michelangelo

NEW ARTISTIC TECHNIQUES

Renaissance artists wanted their work to look realistic. They rediscovered ancient techniques and developed new ones to make their subjects and backgrounds look as much like those in the real world as possible.



LINEAR PERSPECTIVE

Perspective was used to give an artwork a sense of depth. For instance, if an artist drew a line of trees, he would make them smaller and closer together as they got further away from the foreground (front) of the drawing.



AERIAL PERSPECTIVE

Also called atmospheric perspective. It was a way of creating depth and distance, especially in a landscape, by making features paler and less detailed, the further away they got from the foreground.



HARMONY AND PROPORTION

Drawing objects so that they are precisely the right size when compared to each other. Artists rediscovered Ancient Greek and Roman writings, which set out how mathematics could be used to work out ideal proportions. A work of art created in this way would have perfect balance and harmony, they believed.